

# Project 05: Customer Persona + ICP Research



## Customer Persona + ICP Research

**Product Analyzed:** Zerodha (Kite & Coin)

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## Zerodha: The "Reluctant Wealth Builder" Persona



### 1. Persona Overview

**Name:** Rohan (The Reluctant Wealth Builder)

**Demographics:** 26-year-old Software Engineer based in Pune.

**The Goal:** Build long-term wealth through Direct Mutual Funds and Nifty ETFs without learning technical analysis or staring at candlestick charts.



### 2. The "Before" State: Intimidation and Clutter

Before discovering Zerodha, this persona used traditional bank brokers like HDFC Securities or ICICI Direct. They found the legacy banking interfaces completely overwhelming. The traditional platforms were built for aggressive traders, leaving new investors confused by the sheer volume of numbers on the screen.

*"Started my investing journey with HDFC Sec because I had my salary account there. The UI was straight out of 2010 and the brokerage charges were eating into my small SIPs. Completely confusing."*

Worse, traditional brokers rely heavily on relationship managers. This persona hates being called on the phone with "hot stock tips." They feel manipulated and anxious when financial products are pushed onto them.

*"Always found the stock market very intimidating. My dad's traditional broker used to call with tips and it felt shady. I just wanted a simple app where I could buy Nifty 50 ETFs and sleep."*



### 3. The "Aha" Moment: Silence and Simplicity

The first activation moment happens the second they log into Kite. They expect flashing lights and aggressive "buy now" buttons. Instead, they find absolute minimalism. Zerodha does not gamify the trading experience.

*"The moment I logged into Kite, it was a breath of fresh air. No marketing banners, no 'hot stock' recommendations. Just a clean, no-frills UI. Perfect for a beginner who just wants to invest and log out."*

The second activation moment happens on Zerodha Coin. This persona realizes they can set up an automated SIP in under two minutes. More importantly, they realize they are saving a massive amount of money by investing in Direct Mutual Funds instead of Regular ones.

*"Setting up a mutual fund SIP on Coin literally took me 2 minutes. The fact that they offer direct MFs in demat form without any hidden commissions was my 'aha' moment."*

## 4. The Switching Triggers: Trust Over Features

This persona often trials heavily marketed competitor apps like Groww or Upstox before settling on Zerodha. They switch to Zerodha because of the brand's ethical positioning. Nithin Kamath's transparency and the company's "build in public" philosophy create a deep sense of safety.

*"I initially started with Groww because it looked simpler, but switched to Zerodha once I got serious about my investments. Nithin Kamath's transparency and their ethical philosophy won my trust."*

They also switch to escape aggressive sales tactics. Zerodha's strict "no spam" policy is a massive competitive moat. The peace of mind of zero pushy sales calls is easily worth the ₹300 Annual Maintenance Charge to this demographic.

*"Switched from my previous broker because of the constant spam calls and SMS. Zerodha has never once called me to push a trade or sell a loan. That peace of mind is worth the ₹300 AMC."*

## 5. The Friction: Jargon and Support Walls

Despite the clean UI, the underlying mechanics of the stock market bleed through. Zerodha uses industry-standard jargon that terrifies beginners. Terms like "MIS" versus "CNC" cause extreme anxiety for users who just want to buy a stock and hold it forever.

*"Zerodha's UI looks simple but the terminology is intimidating for a newbie. I still remember panicking because I didn't know the difference between MIS and CNC and my position got auto-squared off."*

The second major friction point is customer support. Zerodha operates a highly efficient, ticket-based support system. This scales well for the company but frustrates users who are panicking about a failed bank mandate and just want to speak to a human being.

*"Their customer support is completely ticket-based and highly scripted. Waited 3 days to get a basic bank mandate issue resolved. Good luck getting a human on the phone quickly."*

Finally, they hate the upfront cost. While competitors offer free account openings to drive acquisition, Zerodha still charges a ₹200 onboarding fee. This creates a psychological barrier for first-time investors.

*"I hate that Zerodha still charges a ₹200 account opening fee and an annual maintenance charge when competitors like Groww are offering free account opening."*

*Methodology: Persona built using 15+ verbatim qualitative data points scraped from r/IndiaInvestments, r/IndianStreetBets, and Google Play Store reviews in September 2026.*